UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

BUILDING TOGETHER

Attracting Members – Growing Freemasonry

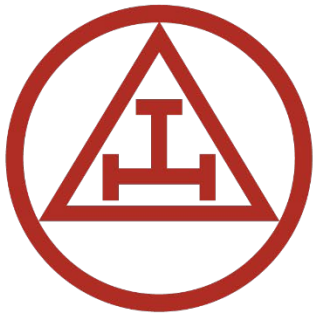
SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS OF ENGLAND



Regional Conference

Sindlesham, September 2025





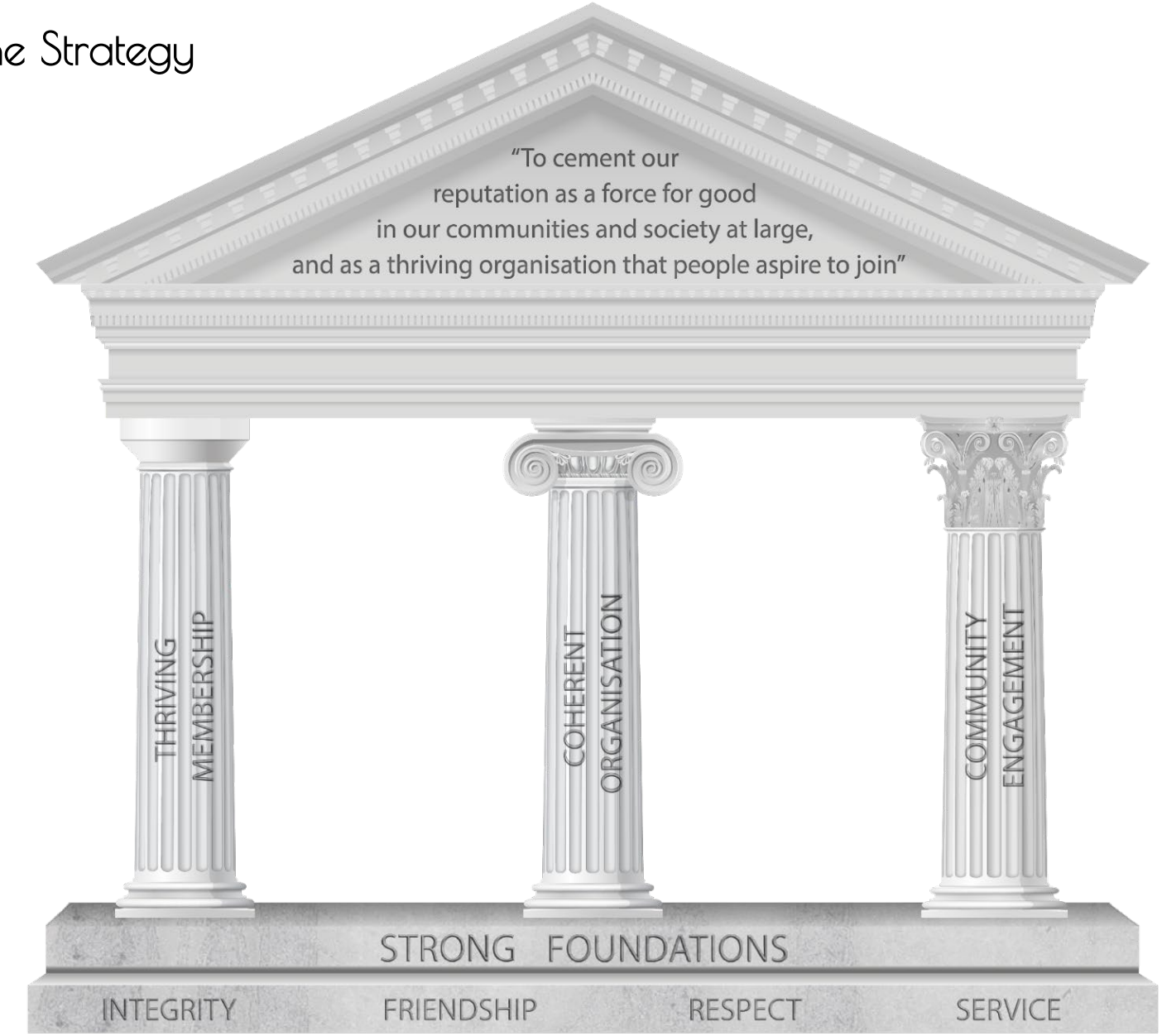
One Journey, One Organisation & The Membership Challenge

Gareth Jones 3rd Grand Principal (Friday)

Sir Michael Snyder ~ Deputy Grand Master (Saturday)

A Reminder of The Strategy

BUILDING TOGETHER



BUILDING TOGETHER

The Membership Challenge Remains our Core Focus



- Enjoyment for **all** and engagement of **all**
- Local leadership
- We need the members' enthusiastic and active support
- We must focus on both attraction ***AND*** retention

How Will We Know Success?



- By 2025, membership of UGLE increasing by 1% per annum
- By 2029, membership of UGLE increasing by 2% per annum
- Improving participation in the Royal Arch in Metropolitan and all Provinces & Districts
- Percentage of Initiates resigning within three years to be below 10% by 2025 and below 5% by 2029
- Metropolitan, Provinces & Districts to improve year-on-year their Membership Challenge from 2025

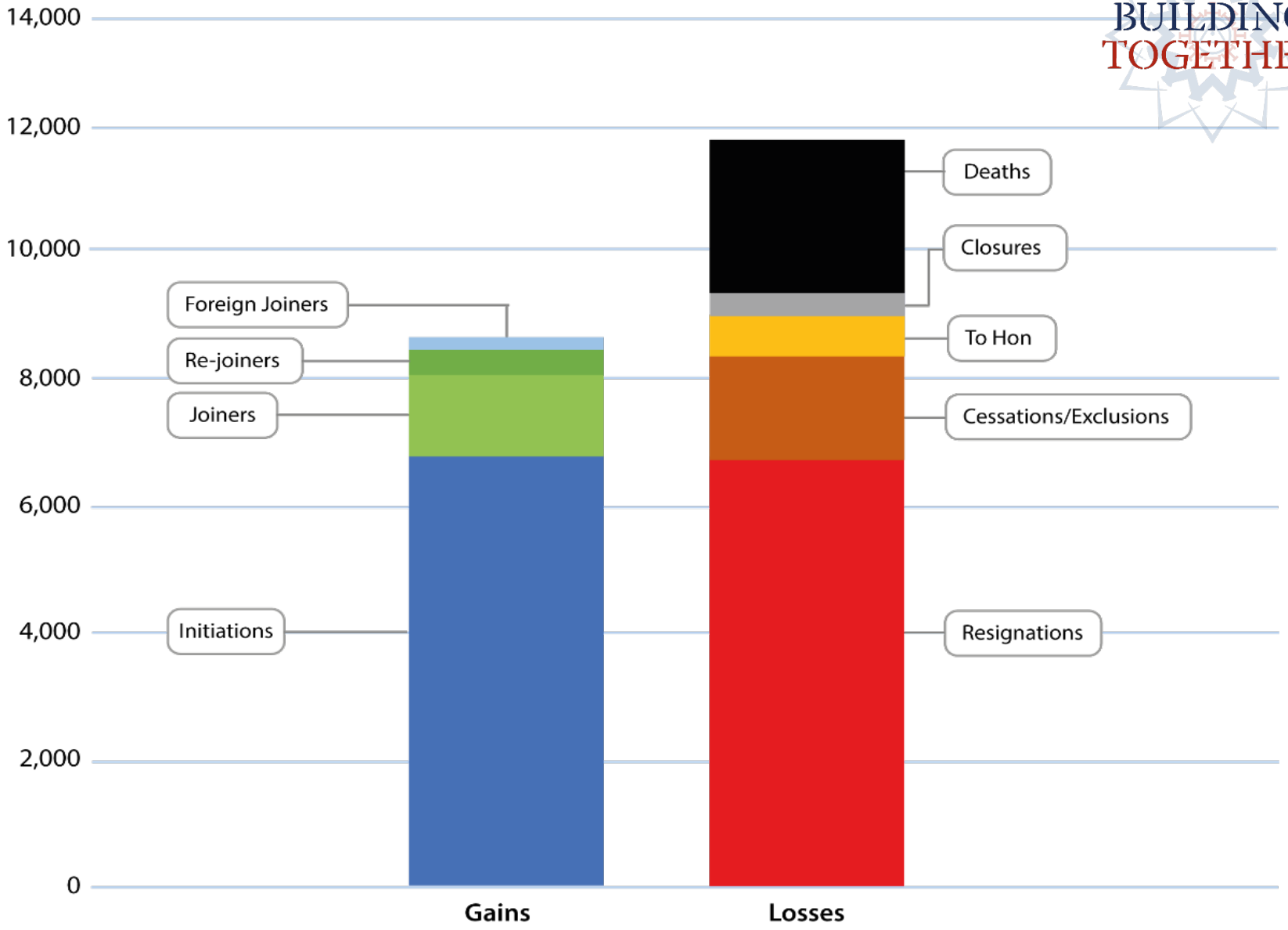
UGLE Membership Challenge: 2019

46% - An Extra

3429 Members Required



BUILDING TOGETHER



UGLE Membership Challenge: 2022

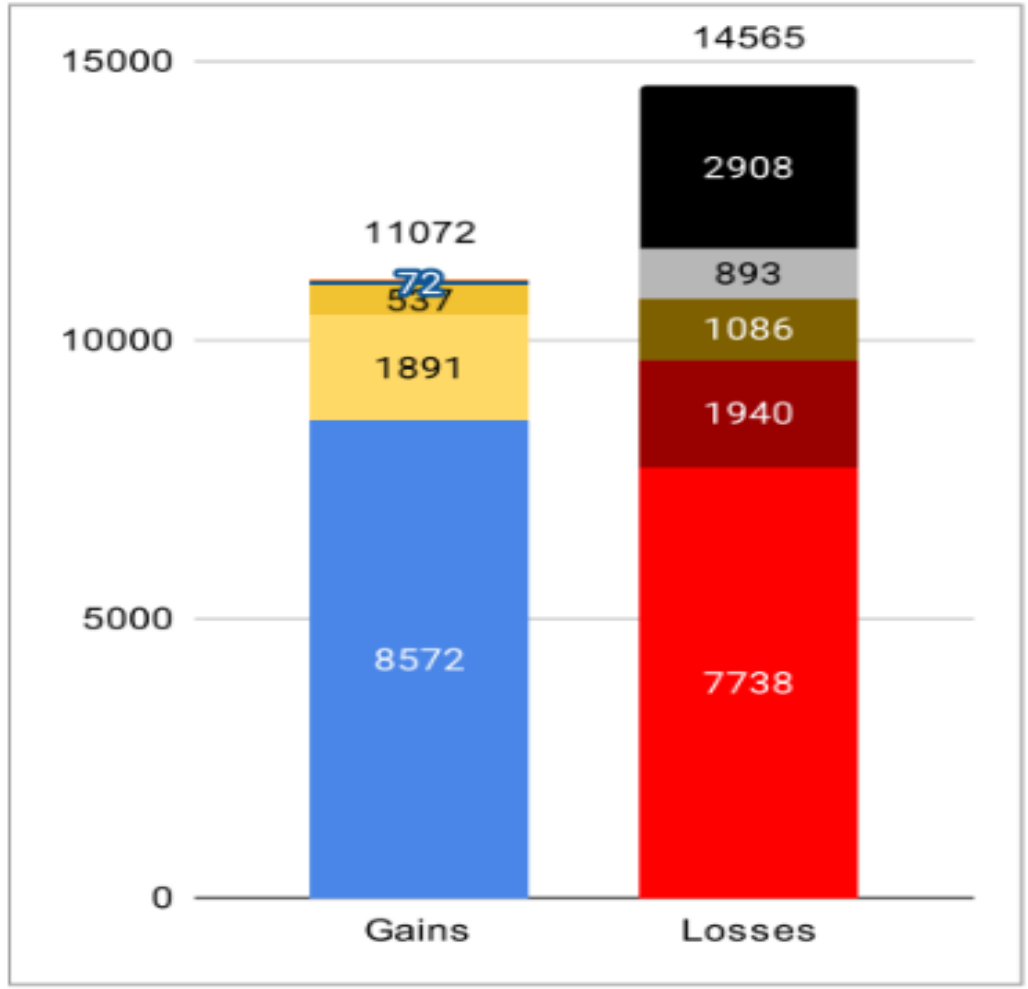
41% - An Extra

3493 Members Required



Initiate
Joiner
Re-joiner
Founder

Resigned
Cessation
Honorary
Closure
Deceased



Membership Challenge: increase Initiates by an extra 41% – an extra 3493

- *"Resigned" includes Resignations under R183A*
- *"Cessation" includes Exclusions and Expulsions*
- *"Closure" includes Amalgamations, which are then also counted as Joiners in the new Lodge*

UGLE Membership Challenge: 2023

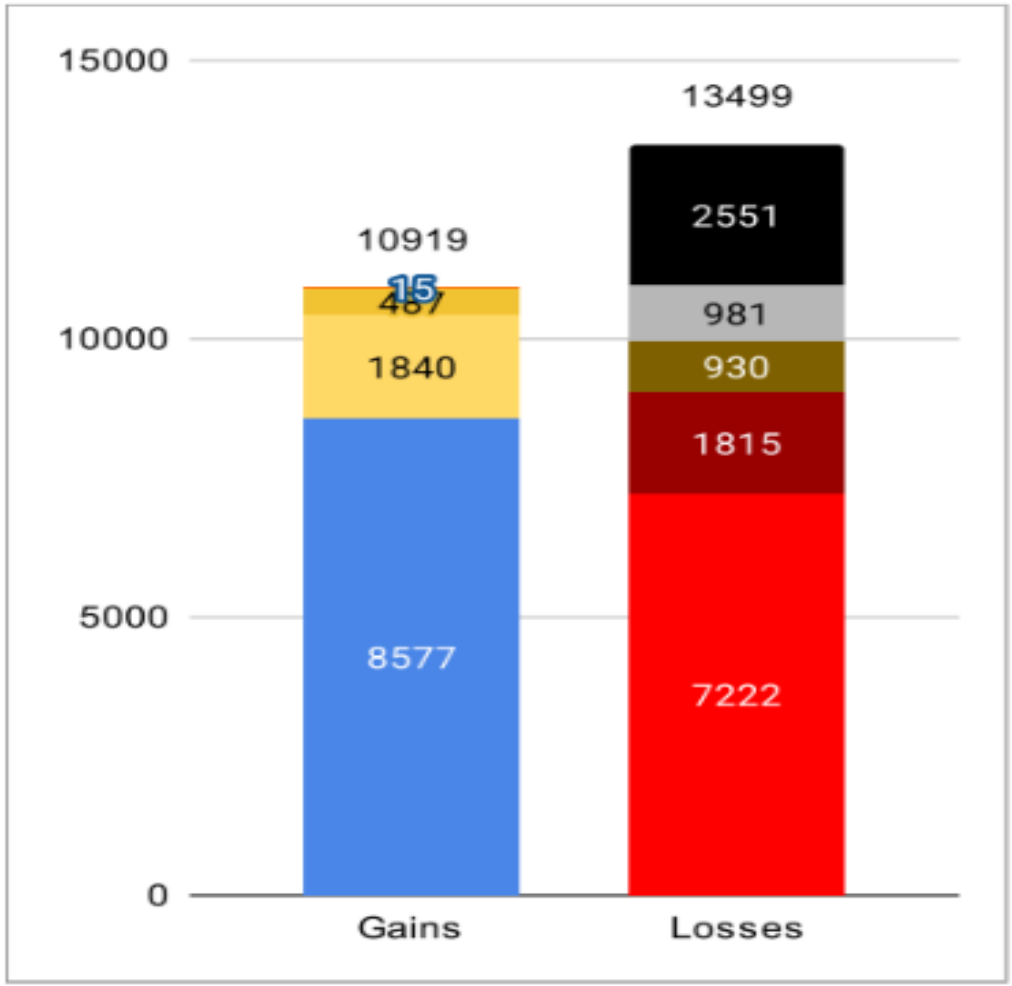
30% - An Extra

2580 Members Required



Initiate
Joiner
Re-joiner
Founder

Resigned
Cessation
Honorary
Closure
Deceased



Membership Challenge: increase Initiates by an extra 30% – an extra 2580

- *"Resigned" includes Resignations under R183A*
- *"Cessation" includes Exclusions and Expulsions*
- *"Closure" includes Amalgamations, which are then also counted as Joiners in the new Lodge*

Progress of Metropolitan, Provincial and District Grand Lodges

BUILDING TOGETHER

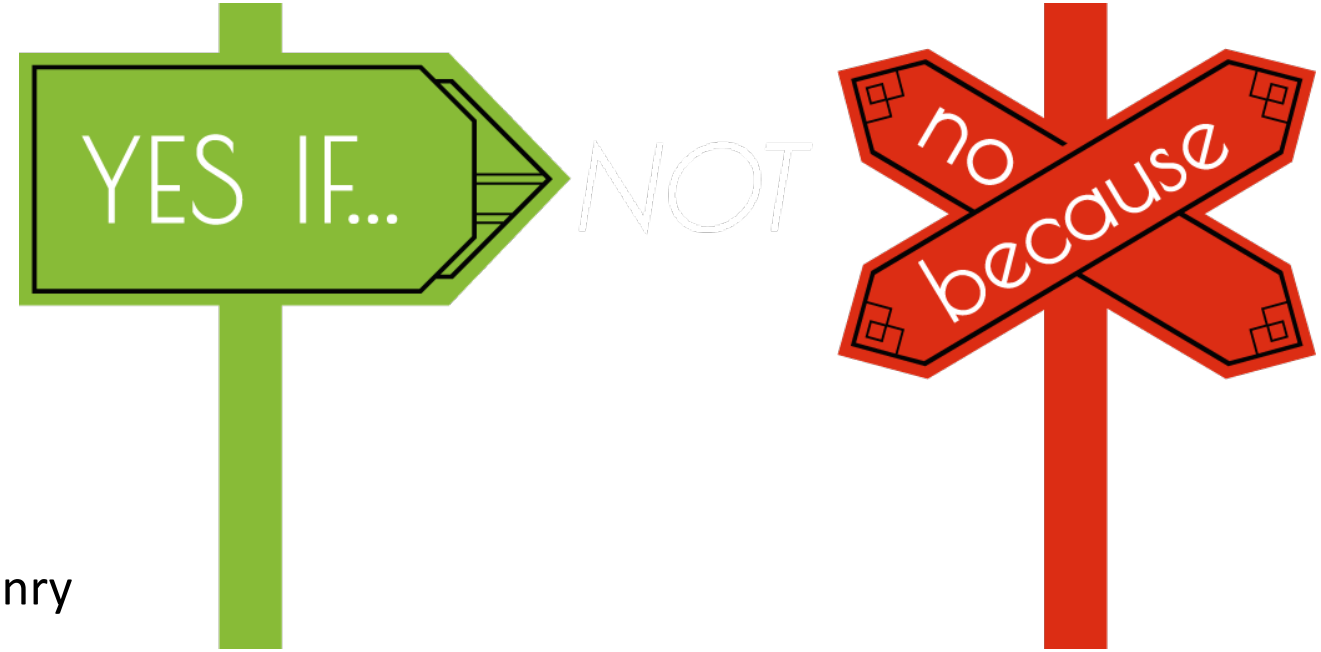
- 23 Provinces are either growing or making good progress on addressing their Membership Challenge
- 17 Provinces are grappling with the Membership Challenge and endeavouring to make progress
- 24 Districts are growing
- 6 Districts are grappling with the Membership Challenge



Some Key Actions Delivered

BUILDING TOGETHER

- Reinforcing Strong Foundations - including Portal
- Multiple candidate ceremonies
- One Journey, One Organisation
- Simplifying the path for joining members
- Ongoing reform of the BoC
- Establishment of the Council for Freemasonry
- Third Pillar Review



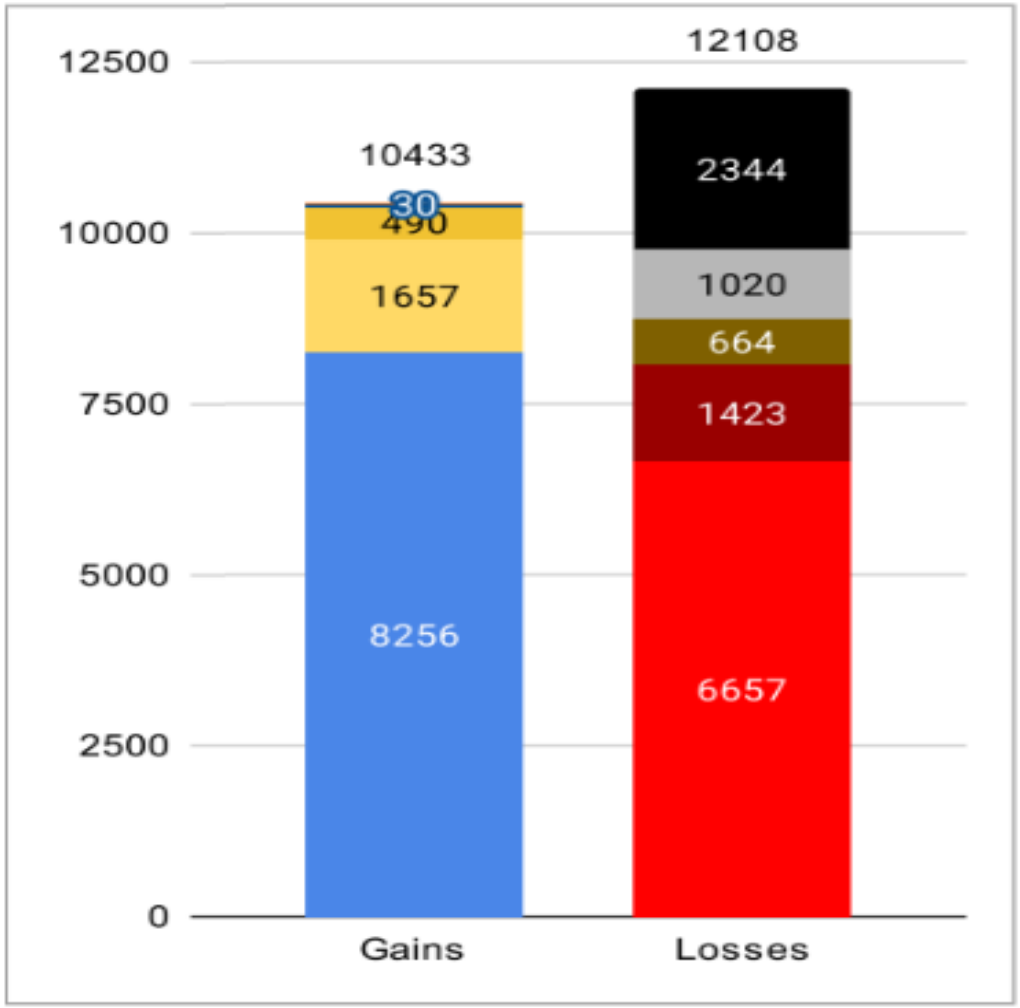
UGLE Membership Challenge: 2024

20% - An Extra 1

1675 Members Required



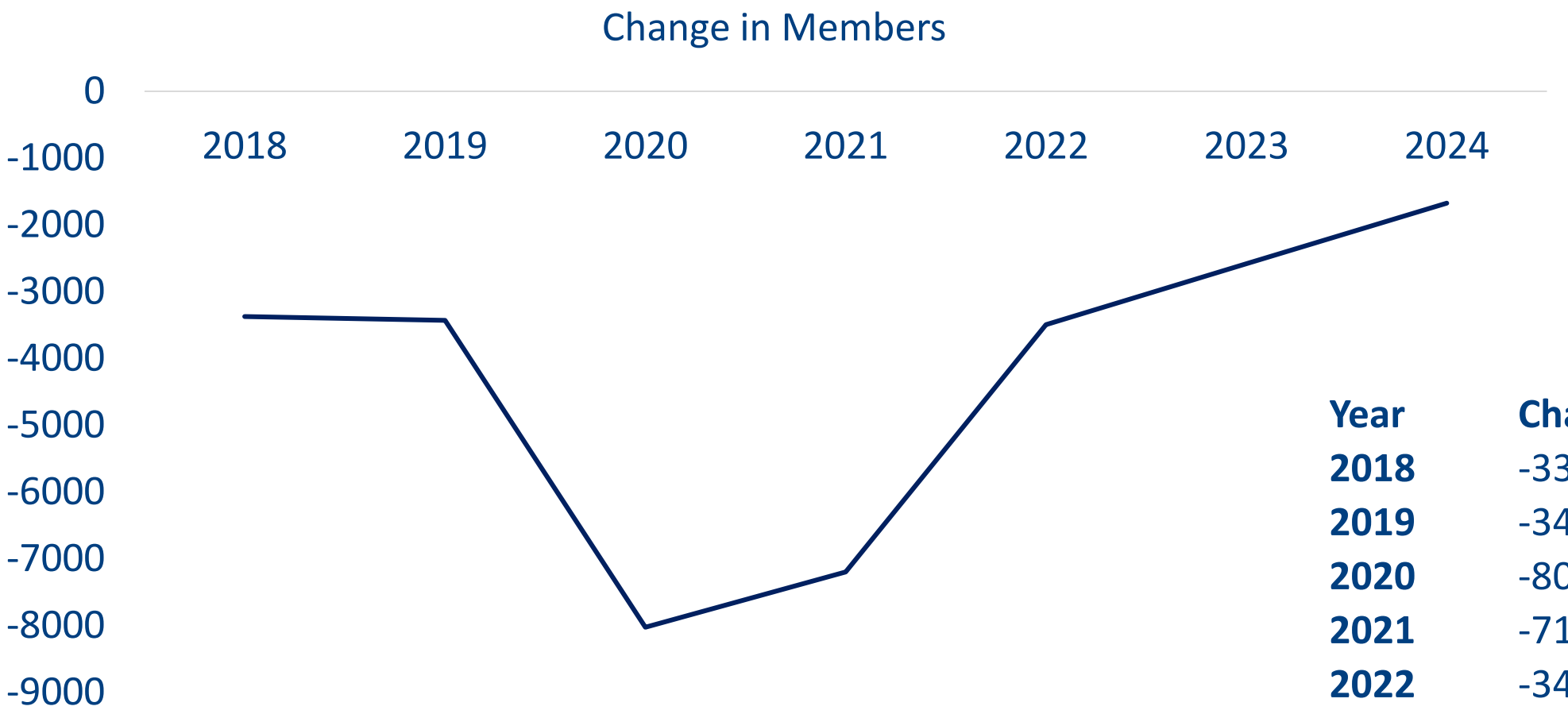




Membership Challenge: increase Initiates by an extra 20% – an extra 1675

- *"Resigned" includes Resignations under R183A*
- *"Cessation" includes Exclusions and Expulsions*
- *"Closure" includes Amalgamations, which are then also counted as Joiners in the new Lodge*

Progress on Addressing Losses Since 2018



Year	Change in Members
2018	-3372
2019	-3429
2020	-8025
2021	-7199
2022	-3493
2023	-2580
2024	-1675

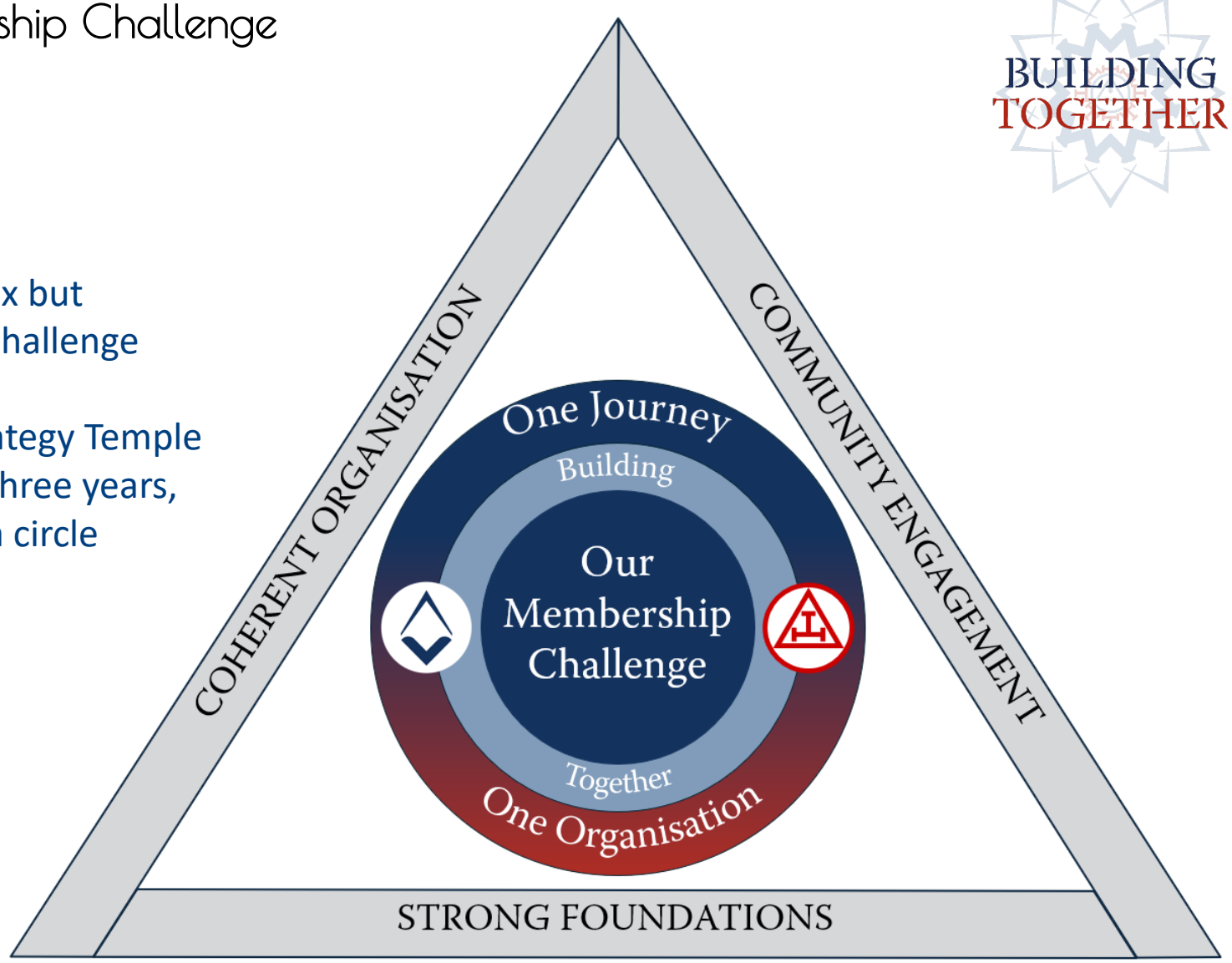
Summary Of Where We Are Now

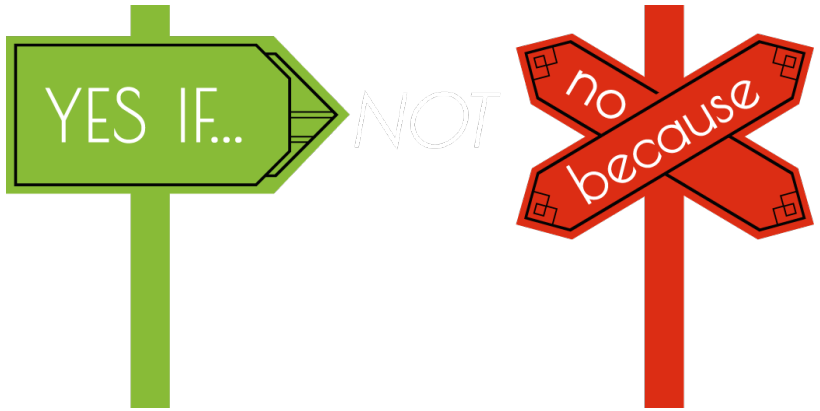


- Much done
- Progress is encouraging
- Lowest level of losses in many, many years
- The Brethren have and are responding
- But still more to do to ensure we deliver the thriving organisation
- We cannot become complacent

Our Reinforced Focus on the Membership Challenge

- Given progress made, we must not relax but strengthen our focus on Membership Challenge
- This new graphic complements the Strategy Temple - emphasising our focus over the next three years, within the familiar masonic symbol of a circle within a triangle





Harmonisation

Chris Hirst

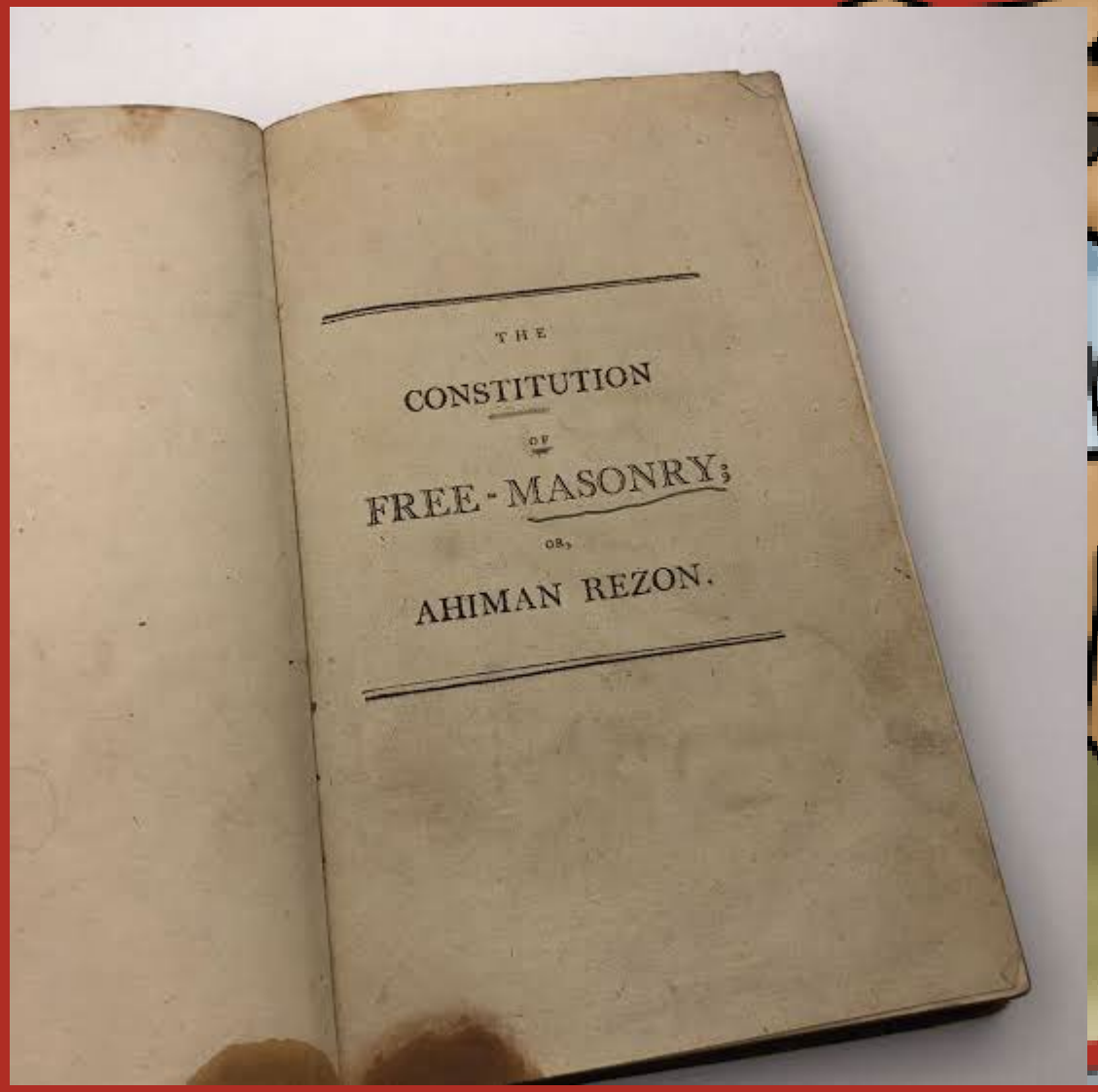
Deputy Chairman,
Building Together Delivery Group

Matthew Hampson

Dept MetGM &
President, Committee General Purposes

The Preliminary Declaration of 1813 states (in original form)

By the solemn Act of Union between the two Grand Lodges of Free-Masons of England in December 1813, it was 'declared and pronounced that pure Antient Masonry consists of three degrees and no more, viz., those of the Entered Apprentice, the Fellow Craft, and the Master Mason, including the Supreme Order of the Holy Royal Arch'.

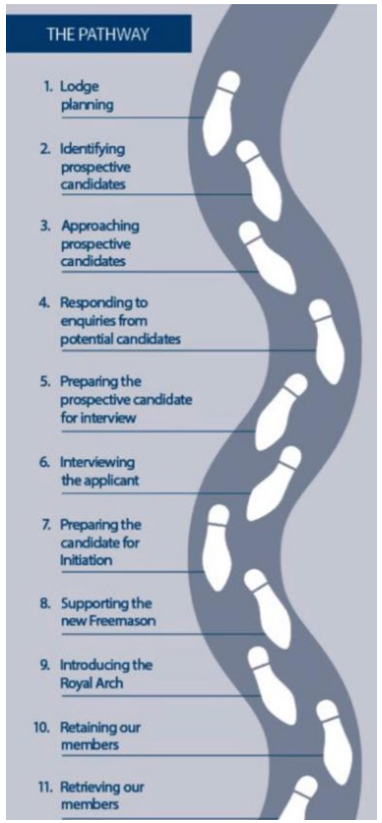

THE
CONSTITUTION
OF
FREE-MASONRY;
OR,
AHIMAN REZON.



The Preliminary Declaration of 1813 states (in its modern form)

‘When the Antient and Modern Grand Lodges came together to form the United Grand Lodge of England in 1813 they declared that ‘Pure Antient Masonry’ consists of three degrees—the Entered Apprentice, the Fellow Craft, and the Master Mason *including the Royal Arch.’.*





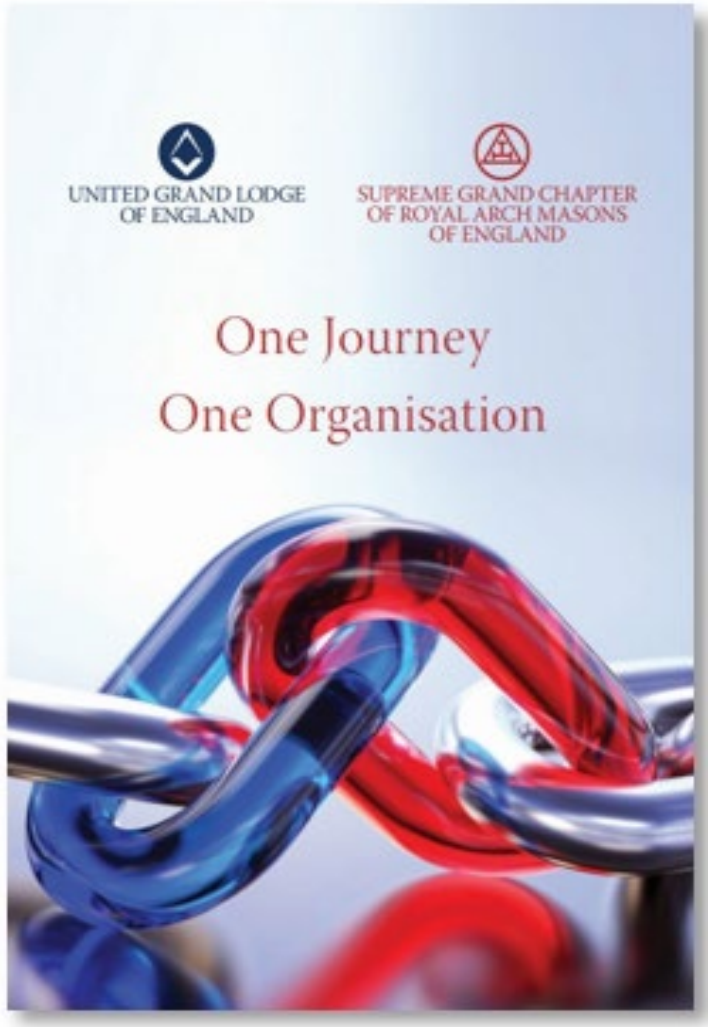
UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND | THE MEMBERS' PATHWAY

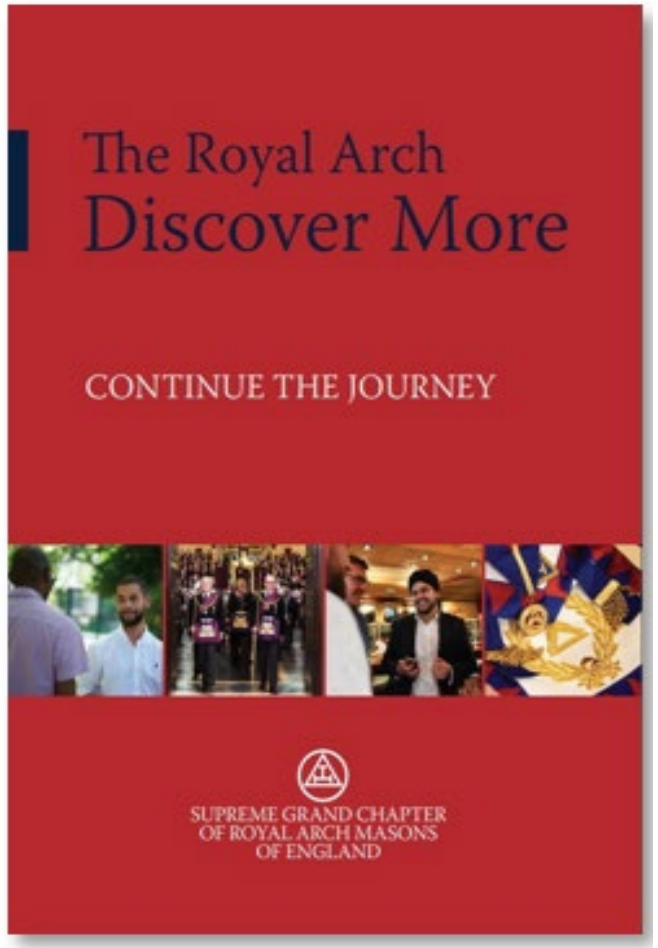


ARCHWAY



What comes from these foundations?


UNITED GRAND LODGE
OF ENGLAND
SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER
OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS
OF ENGLAND
One Journey
One Organisation


The Royal Arch
Discover More
CONTINUE THE JOURNEY
SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER
OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS
OF ENGLAND


The Royal Arch
Welcome
Companion
A Narrative for the
21st Century Freemason
SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER
OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS
OF ENGLAND

One Journey, One Organisation

- **Join Freemasonry not a Lodge**

- **Message:**

  When enquirers apply to join a Lodge, expectations are set that the Individual is joining FREEMASONRY and not just a Lodge.

  It comprises four ceremonies; three in a Craft Lodge and one in a Royal Arch Chapter, at a time and place of your choosing.

BUILDING TOGETHER

One Journey, One Organisation - *One Vocabulary*

- Independent Enquiry Opposed to an Unsponsored Candidate
- Unit is the collective noun which covers Lodges and Chapters
- Province is the collective noun which covers Provinces, Districts and the Metropolitan
- Unit Outline – information which gives a potential member an informed choice
- Unit Profile – internal document which helps a Unit focus on the prospective members they look to attract.
- No longer Propose and Second Candidates for Royal Arch Chapter, but Sponsor them
- Mentor introduced into Royal Arch

BUILDING TOGETHER

One Journey One Organisation – Language to Avoid



- It's the Royal Arch *not* The Holy Royal Arch
- Should not describe the Royal Arch as a "Supreme Order"
- The Royal Arch is *not* the "Fourth Degree"
- The Royal Arch "does not complete the third degree"

Provincial Membership Team

(Suggested Change)



- **Provinces look to appoint one Single Point of Contact**
- **Suggested this should be an active or recently serving member of the Provincial Executive**
- **SPOCs will be responsible for liaision with Provincial Building Together Delivery Group Members across Craft and the Royal Arch**







Introducing

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

BUILDING TOGETHER

Attracting Members – Growing Freemasonry

SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS OF ENGLAND

Chris Hirst

Deputy Chairman, Building Together Delivery Group

Our Lodges

Our Chapters

Our Future

BUILDING TOGETHER

Attracting Members – Growing Freemasonry







Hub

Elements

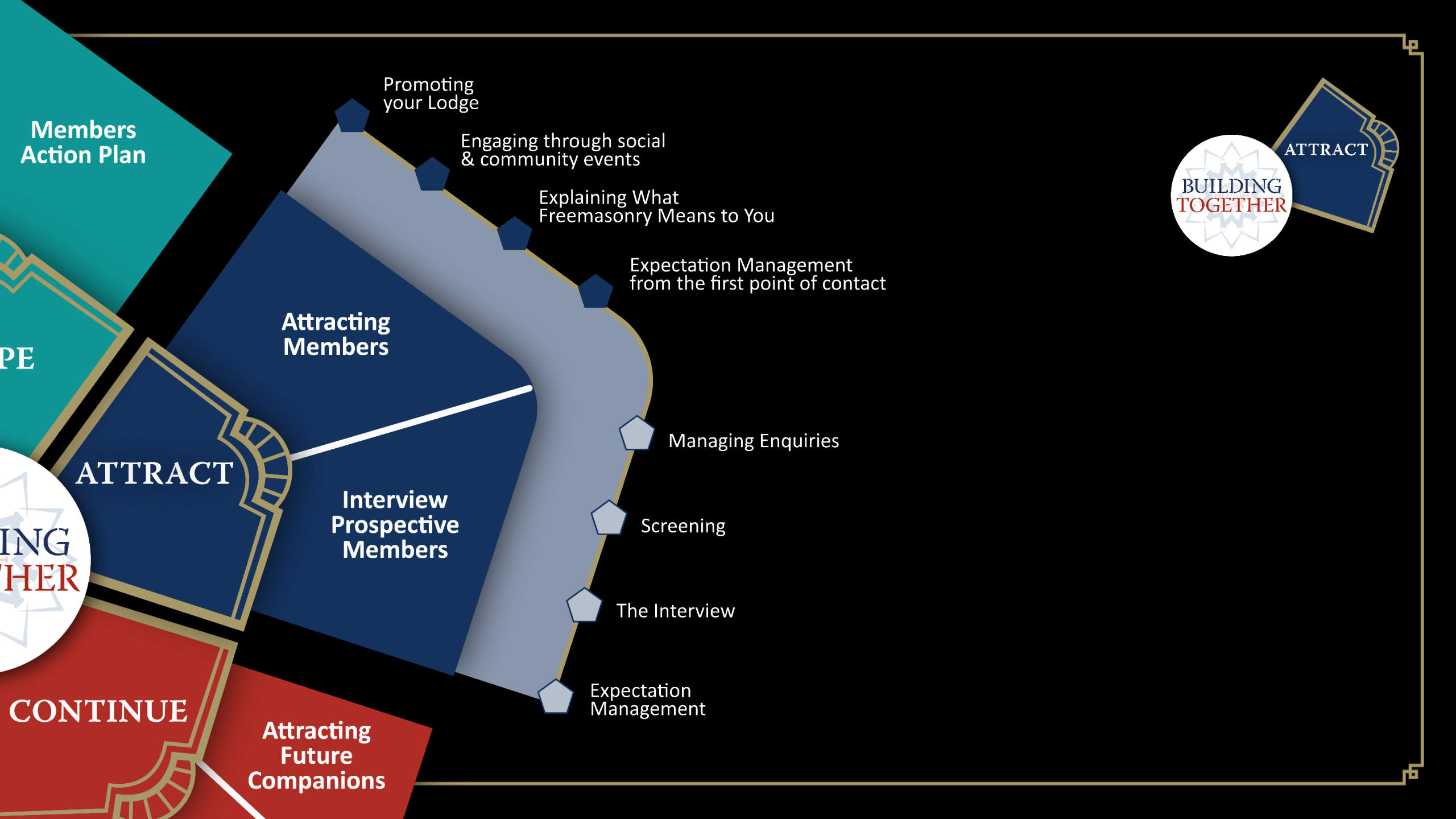
Threads

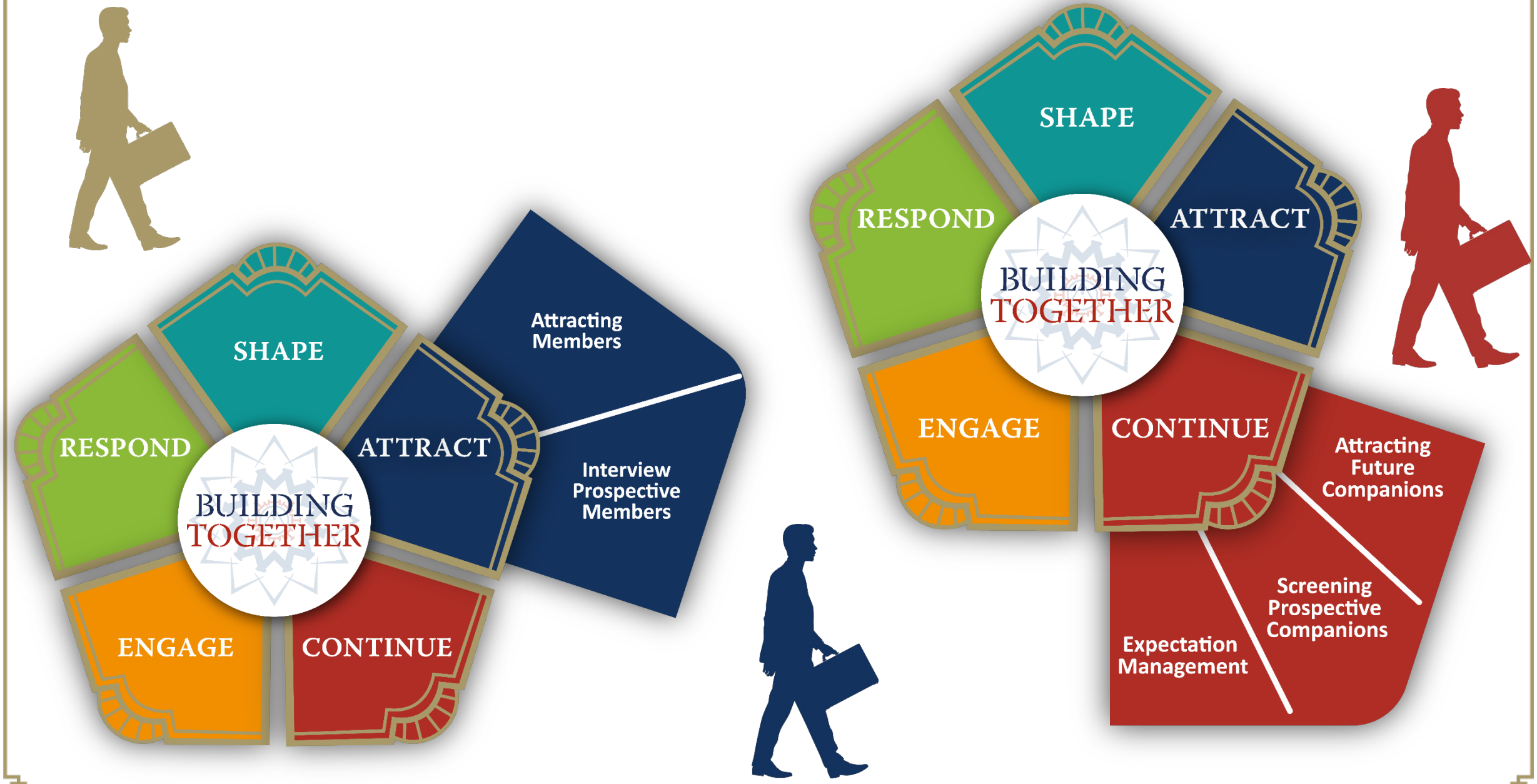

SHAPE
ATTRACT
CONTINUE
ENGAGE
RESPOND
BUILDING
TOGETHER

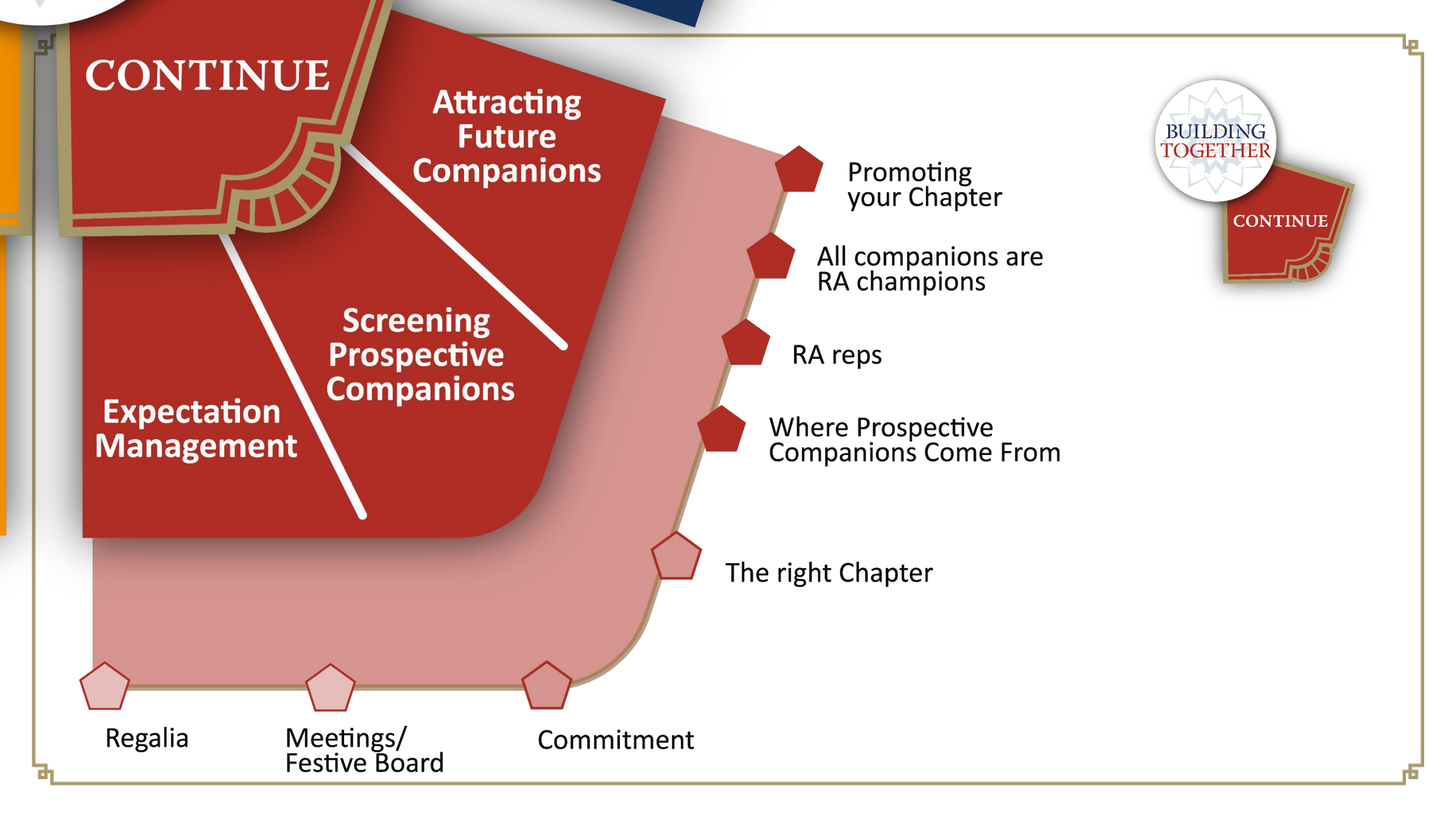

SHAPE
BUILDING
TOGETHER


Review
& Plan
Members
Action Plan
SHAPE
RESPOND
ATTRACT
BUILDING
TOGETHER
ENGAGE
CONTINUE


SHAPE
BUILDING TOGETHER
Succession planning
Preparing your message
Creating a Development Plan
Your Personal Statement
Creating a unit outline
Identifying potential new members
Reviewing your Unit
Review & Plan
Members Action Plan
Alternative Futures
SHAPE
Attracting Members

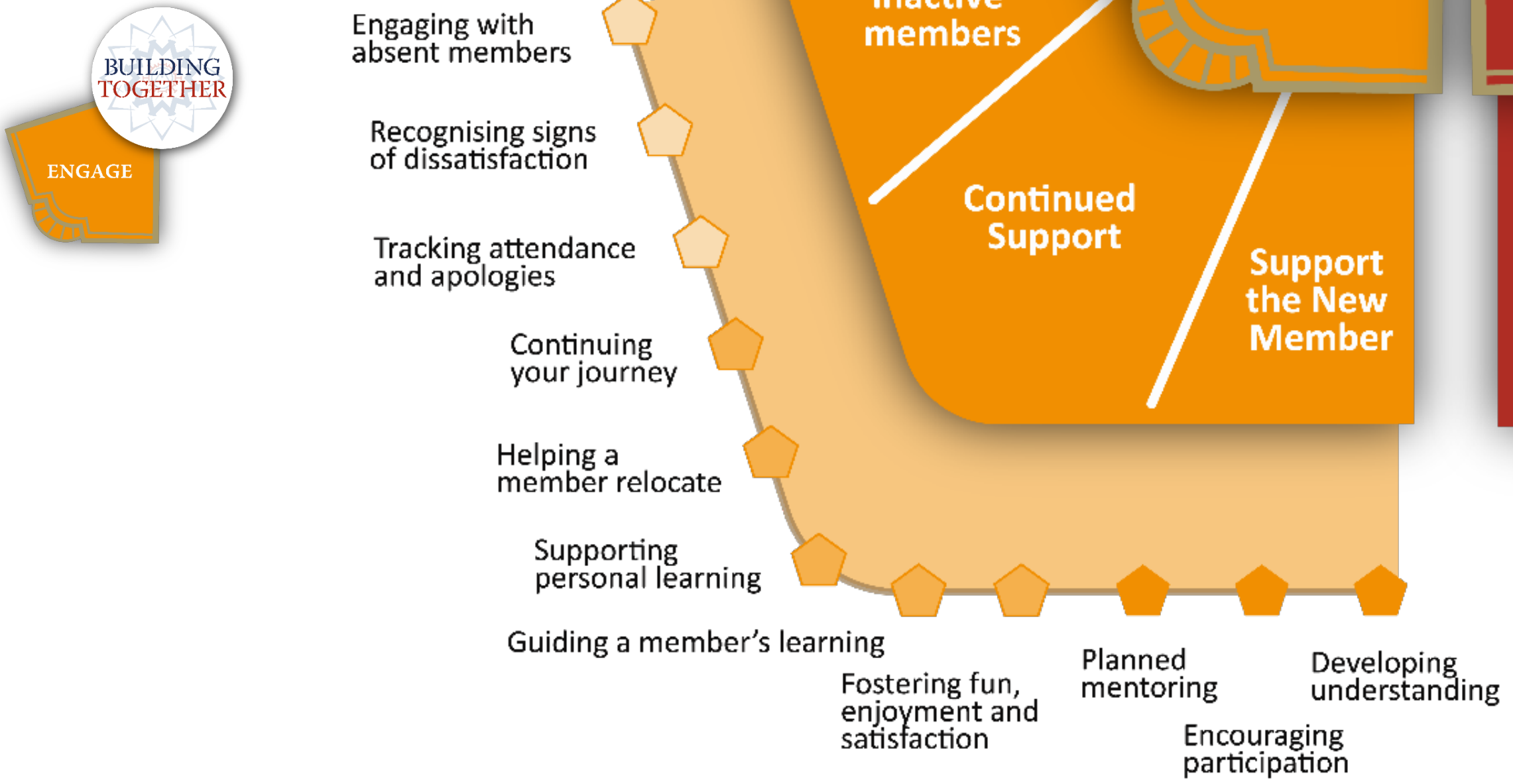

Members Action Plan
PE
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CONTINUE
Attracting Future Companions
ATTRACT
Attracting Members
Interview Prospective Members
Promoting your Lodge
Engaging through social & community events
Explaining What Freemasonry Means to You
Expectation Management from the first point of contact
Managing Enquiries
Screening
The Interview
Expectation Management
ATTRACT
BUILDING TOGETHER

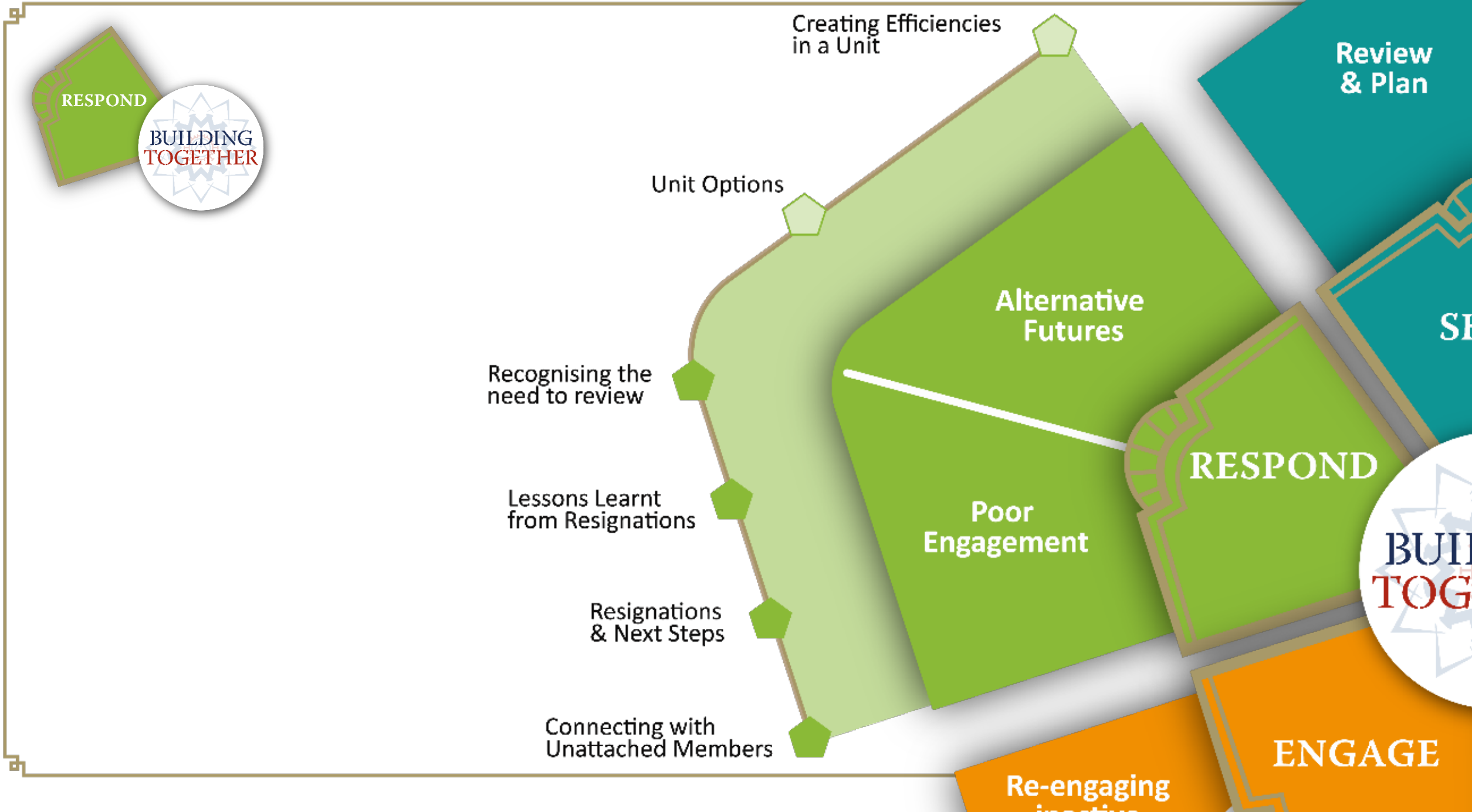

SHAPE
RESPOND
ATTRACT
BUILDING TOGETHER
ENGAGE
CONTINUE
Attracting Members
Interview Prospective Members
SHAPE
RESPOND
ATTRACT
BUILDING TOGETHER
ENGAGE
CONTINUE
Attracting Future Companions
Screening Prospective Companions
Expectation Management


CONTINUE
Attracting Future Companions
Screening Prospective Companions
Expectation Management
Promoting your Chapter
All companions are RA champions
RA reps
Where Prospective Companions Come From
The right Chapter
Regalia
Meetings/ Festive Board
Commitment
BUILDING TOGETHER
CONTINUE


SHAPE
ATTRACT
CONTINUE
ENGAGE
RESPOND
BUILDING TOGETHER
Attracting Future Companions
Screening Prospective Companions
Expectation Management


TOGETHE
ENGAGE
CO
Re-engaging inactive members
Continued Support
Support the New Member
Exp
Mar
Engaging with absent members
Recognising signs of dissatisfaction
Tracking attendance and apologies
Continuing your journey
Helping a member relocate
Supporting personal learning
Guiding a member's learning
Fostering fun, enjoyment and satisfaction
Planned mentoring
Developing understanding
Encouraging participation


BUILDING TOGETHER
ENGAGE
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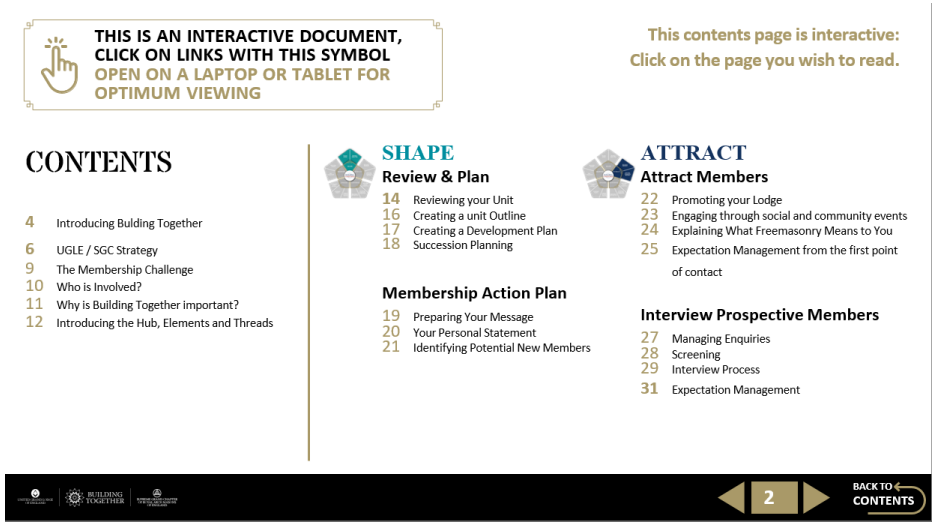

RESPOND
BUILDING TOGETHER
Creating Efficiencies in a Unit
Review & Plan
Unit Options
Alternative Futures
Recognising the need to review
Lessons Learnt from Resignations
Poor Engagement
RESPOND
Resignations & Next Steps
Connecting with Unattached Members
ENGAGE
Re-engaging

Hub Language Changes

- Shape rather than plan in the Hub
- Invited to Continue your journey
- Continue – Hub Section which covers Royal Arch attraction up to the point of exaltation
- Respond rather than plan in the Retrieve

Interactive Quick Start Guide PDF





THIS IS AN INTERACTIVE DOCUMENT, CLICK ON LINKS WITH THIS SYMBOL
OPEN ON A LAPTOP OR TABLET FOR OPTIMUM VIEWING

This contents page is interactive: Click on the page you wish to read.

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4 Introducing Bulding Together

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9 The Membership Challenge
10 Who is Involved?
11 Why is Building Together important?
12 Introducing the Hub, Elements and Threads

SHAPE

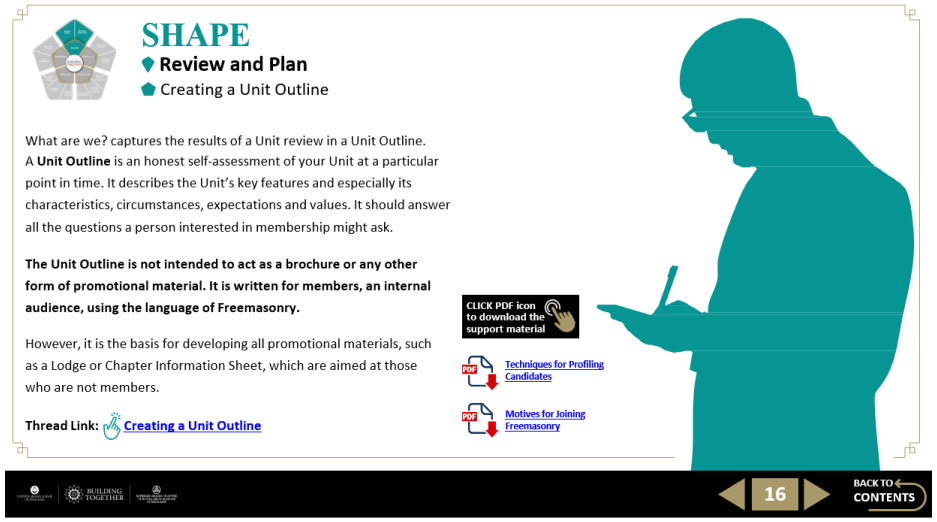
Review & Plan
14 Reviewing your Unit
16 Creating a unit Outline
17 Creating a Development Plan
18 Succession Planning

Membership Action Plan
19 Preparing Your Message
20 Your Personal Statement
21 Identifying Potential New Members

ATTRACT

Attract Members
22 Promoting your Lodge
23 Engaging through social and community events
24 Explaining What Freemasonry Means to You
25 Expectation Management from the first point of contact

Interview Prospective Members
27 Managing Enquiries
28 Screening
29 Interview Process
31 Expectation Management



SHAPE

Review and Plan

Creating a Unit Outline

What are we? captures the results of a Unit review in a Unit Outline. A **Unit Outline** is an honest self-assessment of your Unit at a particular point in time. It describes the Unit's key features and especially its characteristics, circumstances, expectations and values. It should answer all the questions a person interested in membership might ask.

The Unit Outline is not intended to act as a brochure or any other form of promotional material. It is written for members, an internal audience, using the language of Freemasonry.

However, it is the basis for developing all promotional materials, such as a Lodge or Chapter Information Sheet, which are aimed at those who are not members.

Thread Link: Creating a Unit Outline

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

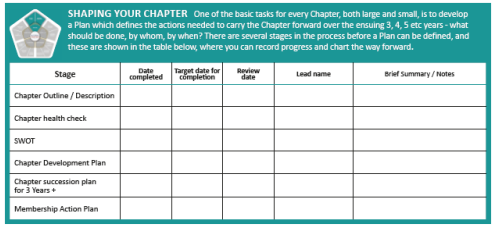
Techniques for Profiling Candidates

Motives for Joining Freemasonry



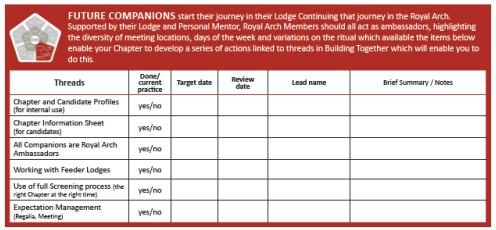
Unit Progress Records





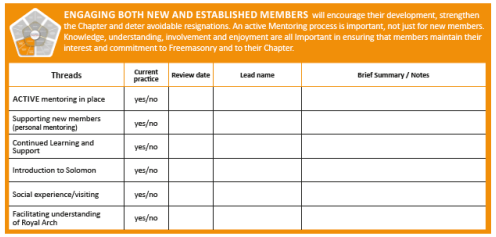
SHAPING YOUR CHAPTER One of the basic tasks for every Chapter, both large and small, is to develop a Plan which defines the actions needed to carry the Chapter forward over the ensuing 3, 4, 5 etc years - what should be done, by whom, by when? There are several stages in the process before a Plan can be defined, and these are shown in the table below, where you can record progress and chart the way forward.

Stage	Date completed	Target date for completion	Review date	Lead name	Brief Summary / Notes
Chapter Outline / Description					
Chapter health check					
SWOT					
Chapter Development Plan					
Chapter succession plan for 3 Years +					
Membership Action Plan					



FUTURE COMPANIONS start their journey in their Lodge Continuing that journey in the Royal Arch. Supported by their Lodge and Personal Mentor, Royal Arch Members should all act as ambassadors, highlighting the diversity of meeting locations, days of the week and variations on the ritual which available the items below enable your Chapter to develop a series of actions linked to threads in Building Together which will enable you to do this.

Threads	Done/ current practice	Target date	Review date	Lead name	Brief Summary / Notes
Chapter and Candidate Profiles (for internal use)	yes/no				
Chapter Information Sheet (for candidates)	yes/no				
All Companions are Royal Arch Ambassadors	yes/no				
Working with Feeder Lodges	yes/no				
Use of full Screening process (the right Chapter at the right time)	yes/no				
Expectation Management (Regalia, Meeting)	yes/no				

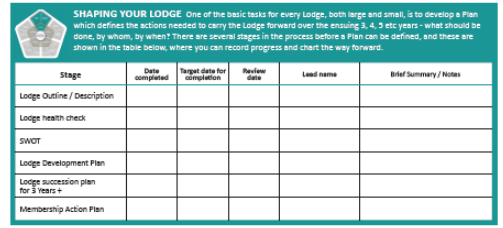


ENGAGING BOTH NEW AND ESTABLISHED MEMBERS will encourage their development, strengthen the Chapter and deter avoidable resignations. An active Mentoring process is important, not just for new members. Knowledge, understanding, involvement and enjoyment are all important in ensuring that members maintain their interest and commitment to Freemasonry and to their Chapter.

Threads	Current practice	Review date	Lead name	Brief Summary / Notes
ACTIVE mentoring in place	yes/no			
Supporting new members (personal mentoring)	yes/no			
Continued Learning and Support	yes/no			
Introduction to Solomon	yes/no			
Social experience/visiting	yes/no			
Facilitating understanding of Royal Arch	yes/no			

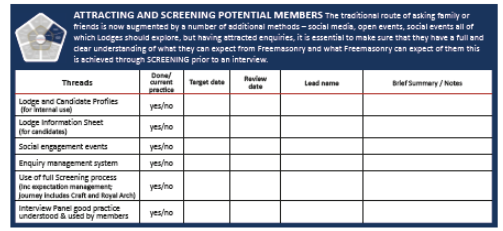
- ***Different for Lodges and Chapters***
- ***Lodge Progress record has an ATTRACT SECTION***
- ***Chapter Progress records have a CONTINUE SECTION***
- ***Electronic version thanks to N&H Team***

Shaun and Tom from UGLE will be engaging with Provinces to discuss how these are made available



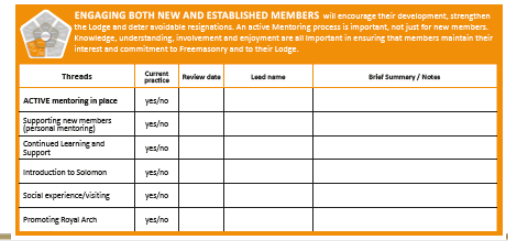
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Lodge health check					
SWOT					
Lodge Development Plan					
Lodge succession plan for 3 Years +					
Membership Action Plan					



ATTRACTING AND SCREENING POTENTIAL MEMBERS The traditional route of asking family or friends is now augmented by a number of additional methods – social media, open events, social events all of which Lodges should explore, but having attracted enquiries, it is essential to make sure that they have a full and clear understanding of what they can expect from Freemasonry and what Freemasonry can expect of them this is achieved through SCREENING prior to an interview.

Threads	Done/ current practice	Target date	Review date	Lead name	Brief Summary / Notes
Lodge and Candidate Profiles (for internal use)	yes/no				
Lodge Information Sheet (for candidates)	yes/no				
Social engagement events	yes/no				
Enquiry management system	yes/no				
Use of full Screening process (inc expectation management; Journey includes Craft and Royal Arch)	yes/no				
Interview Panel good practice understood & used by members	yes/no				

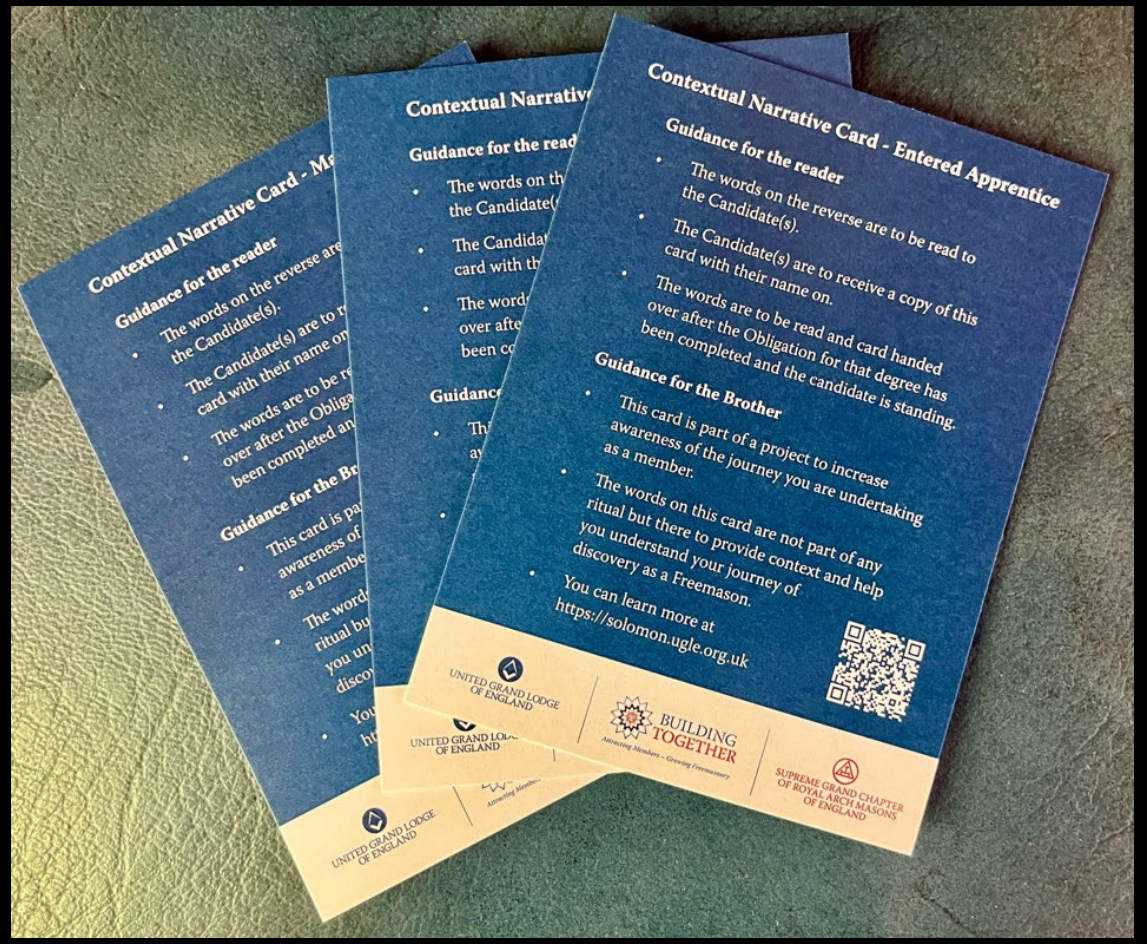


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Continued Learning and Support	yes/no			
Introduction to Solomon	yes/no			
Social experience/visiting	yes/no			
Promoting Royal Arch	yes/no			



Contextual Narratives



Contextual Narratives – First Degree

Brother _____

Congratulations on taking your first regular step on your journey through pure and antient Freemasonry. This was set out in the Union of 1813, when the United Grand Lodge of England decreed that, “This consists of three degrees and no more; namely those of the Entered Apprentice, the Fellow Craft and the Master Mason, including the Order of the Royal Arch.”

No Freemason can truly be said to have completed this journey until all four parts are concluded, climaxing in his Exaltation into the Royal Arch. Rest assured, the brethren of this fine lodge, of which you have, this evening, become a member/members, will afford you every assistance as you progress from Entered Apprentice to Companion of the Royal Arch

Contextual Narratives – Second Degree

Brother _____

Congratulations on completing your second regular step on your journey through pure and antient Freemasonry.

You will, I am sure, recall my directing your attention to the position of the Square and Compasses. As you will have noted, one point was hid, while one was disclosed. I further explained that this symbolised your midway position in Freemasonry.

This evening you have completed the Degree of Fellow Craft, to add to that of Entered Apprentice.

There remains, therefore, two further ceremonies to complete; that of the 3rd Degree, when you will be raised to the sublime Degree of a Master Mason, followed by the climax of your journey when you will be Exalted as a Companion of the Royal Arch

Contextual Narratives – Third Degree

Brother _____

Congratulations on completing your third regular step on your journey through pure and antient Freemasonry.

Having been raised to the Sublime Degree of a Master Mason, you are now in possession of the substituted secrets, the genuine being lost, due to the untimely death of our Master, Hiram Abiff until time or circumstance should restore the genuine.

You are now close to the conclusion of your journey through Pure and Antient Freemasonry, but that which was lost awaits your discovery only when you are Exalted as a Companion of the Royal Arch.

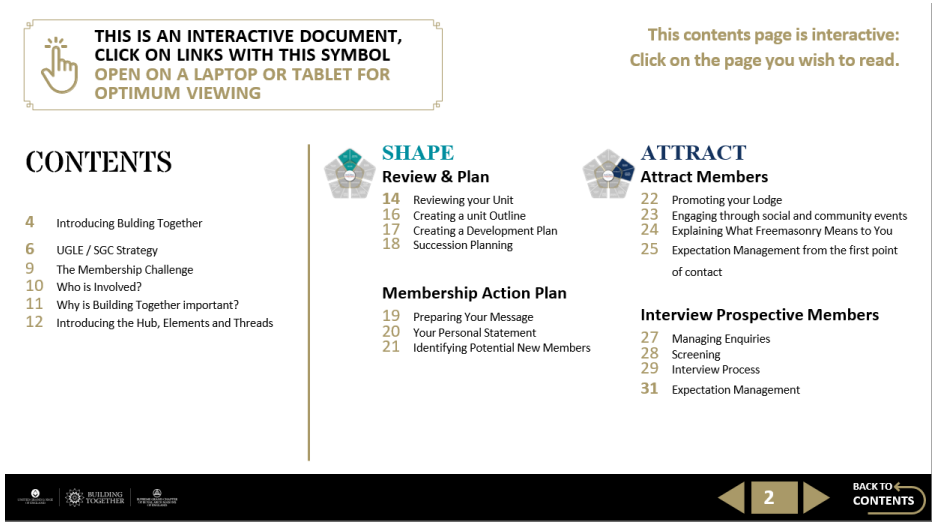


Platform and roll out

Matthew Hampson

Interactive Quick Start Guide PDF





THIS IS AN INTERACTIVE DOCUMENT, CLICK ON LINKS WITH THIS SYMBOL
OPEN ON A LAPTOP OR TABLET FOR OPTIMUM VIEWING

This contents page is interactive: Click on the page you wish to read.

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6 UGLE / SGC Strategy
9 The Membership Challenge
10 Who is Involved?
11 Why is Building Together important?
12 Introducing the Hub, Elements and Threads

SHAPE

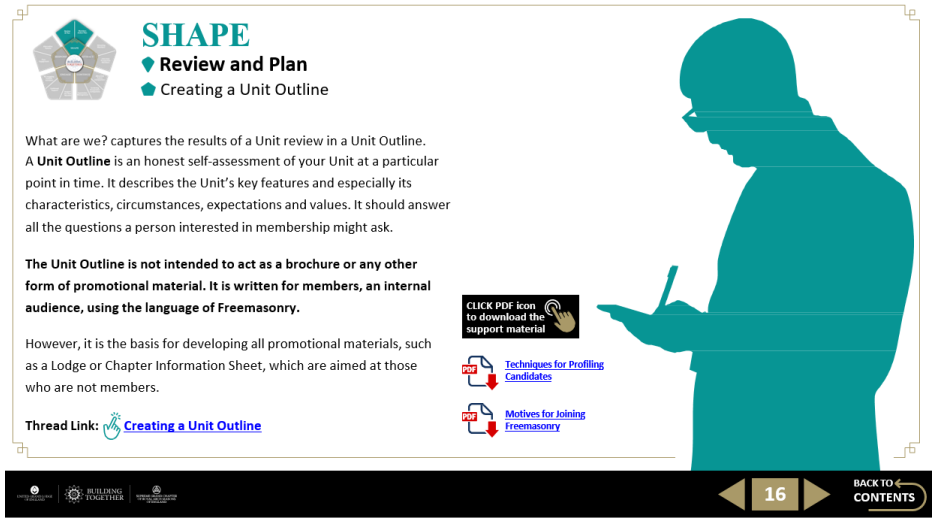
Review & Plan
14 Reviewing your Unit
16 Creating a unit Outline
17 Creating a Development Plan
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Membership Action Plan
19 Preparing Your Message
20 Your Personal Statement
21 Identifying Potential New Members

ATTRACT

Attract Members
22 Promoting your Lodge
23 Engaging through social and community events
24 Explaining What Freemasonry Means to You
25 Expectation Management from the first point of contact

Interview Prospective Members
27 Managing Enquiries
28 Screening
29 Interview Process
31 Expectation Management



SHAPE

Review and Plan

Creating a Unit Outline

What are we? captures the results of a Unit review in a Unit Outline. A **Unit Outline** is an honest self-assessment of your Unit at a particular point in time. It describes the Unit's key features and especially its characteristics, circumstances, expectations and values. It should answer all the questions a person interested in membership might ask.

The Unit Outline is not intended to act as a brochure or any other form of promotional material. It is written for members, an internal audience, using the language of Freemasonry.

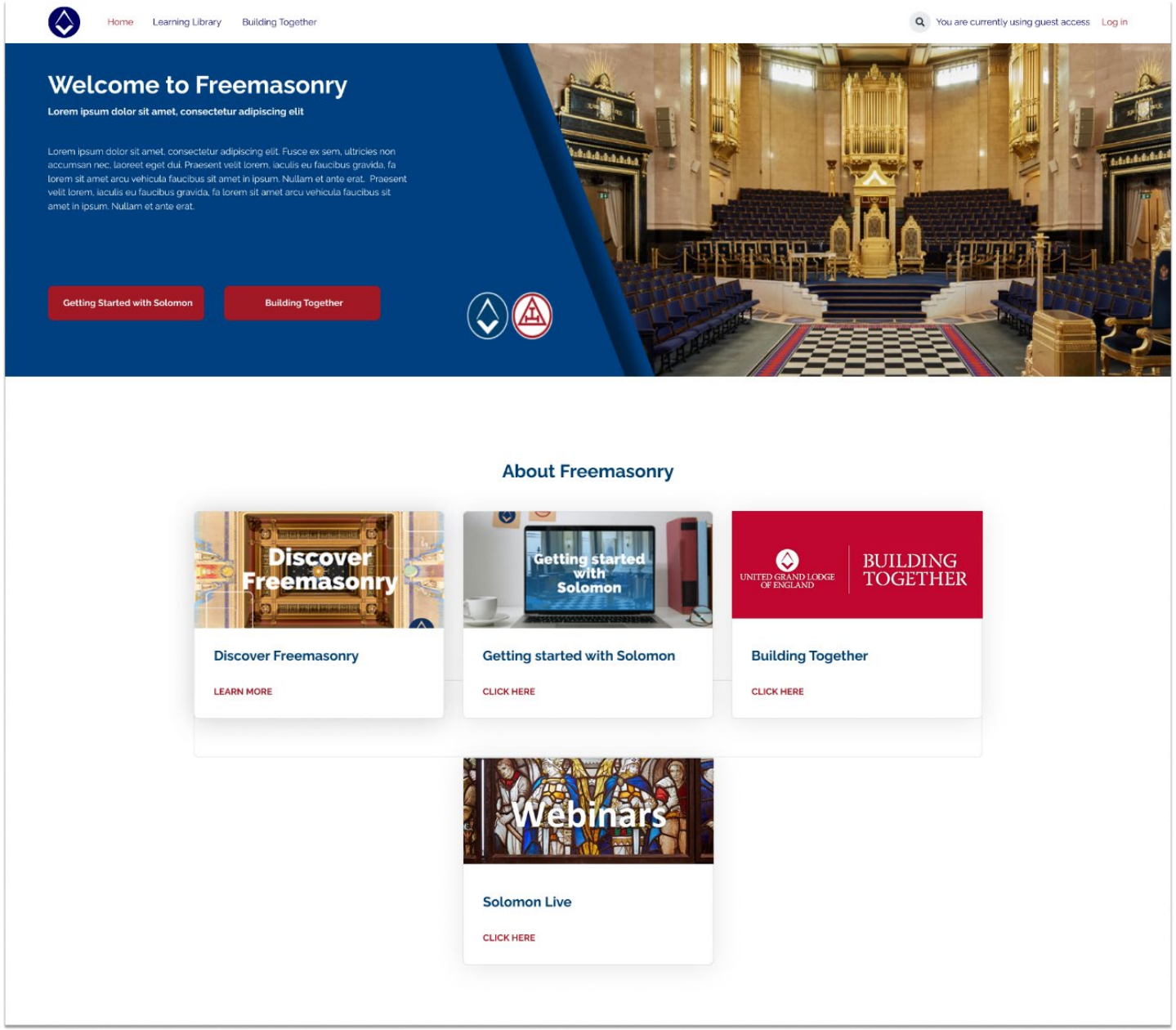
However, it is the basis for developing all promotional materials, such as a Lodge or Chapter Information Sheet, which are aimed at those who are not members.

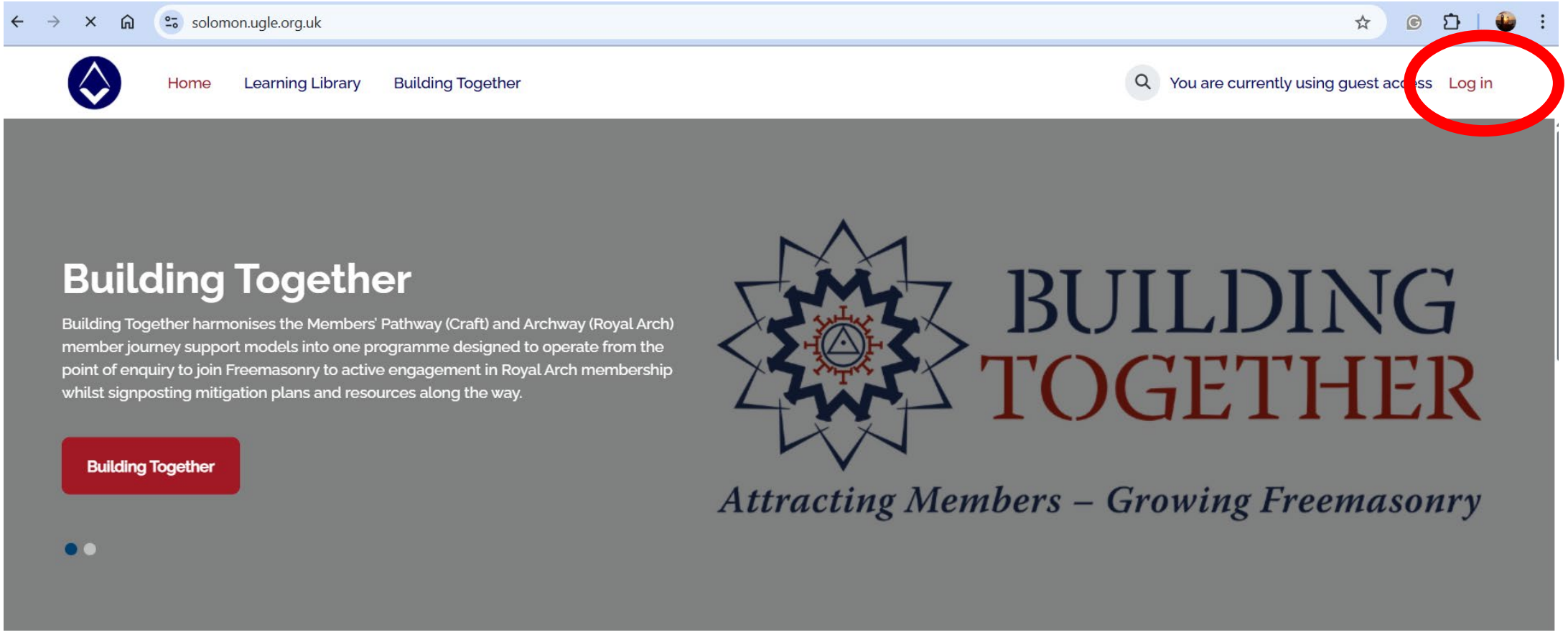
Thread Link: Creating a Unit Outline

CLICK PDF icon to download the support material

Techniques for Profiling Candidates

Motives for Joining Freemasonry


Home
Learning Library
Building Together
You are currently using guest access
Log in
Welcome to Freemasonry
Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit
Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Fusce ex sem, ultricies non accumsan nec, laoreet eget dui. Praesent velit lorem, iaculis eu faucibus gravida, fa lorem sit amet arcu vehicula faucibus sit amet in ipsum. Nullam et ante erat. Praesent velit lorem, iaculis eu faucibus gravida, fa lorem sit amet arcu vehicula faucibus sit amet in ipsum. Nullam et ante erat.
Getting Started with Solomon
Building Together
About Freemasonry
Discover Freemasonry
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Solomon Live
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About Freemasonry



Afternoon Workshops

Andrew Waddington

UNITED GRAND LODGE OF ENGLAND

BUILDING TOGETHER

Attracting Members – Growing Freemasonry

SUPREME GRAND CHAPTER OF ROYAL ARCH MASONS OF ENGLAND

LUNCH

Afternoon Workshops

BUILDING TOGETHER

- **Two separate sessions this afternoon – a coffee break will split them up**
- Where Lunch is served – SPOCs, Membership Officers, Communication Officers **(plus anyone not mentioned for any of the other rooms)**
- Main Temple– Mentors, L&D Officers, Almoners and Retrieval Officers
- Ingham Clark – Rulers (ProvGM & MEGS)

At the end of the first breakouts, we will brief you on the next set